Paweł Mikołajek

Product Designer & Builder

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Summary

I’m a designer who builds. I came up through agency and brand work (Aromen, Webstacks, Ogilvy clients) and joined Human Made in 2022 as its only designer, running the Figma space and making marketing work. Over time the job moved from drawing tools to shipping them: I now design and build the internal products the team works in, from a PDF review tool to a brand system that AI agents can read.

My day-to-day spans Figma systems, UI components, and prototypes; After Effects and Lottie when something needs to move; and React, TypeScript, and Tailwind when a flat mockup isn’t enough. I build those with Claude Code: the AI writes most of the code, and I direct, review and test it so people get a working surface.

Experience

Visual Designer, Human Made

Matlock, UK | Aug 2022 – Present

- Joined as the agency’s only designer and, on my own initiative, grew the role beyond visual design into designing and building internal products end to end (interface, front end and backend) with AI-assisted development in Claude Code.
- Designed and built Sparrow, a PDF review tool in production for the team, with pinned comments, threads resolved in place, and share links to the latest or an exact version (React, PDF.js, TipTap, Express, SQLite).
- Turned the Human Made brand guidelines from a static reference into a suite for people and AI agents: design tokens, editorial voice guidance, an agent skill for Claude Code, Claude.ai, ChatGPT and Slack, and generators for business cards, assets and team diagrams.
- Designed and built Workbench, the marketing team’s planning board, to replace their spreadsheets: a month calendar as home, a forward view of the year’s campaigns, a content calendar by publishing date, and a drafting room for undated ideas (Next.js, SQLite).
- Created and maintained the central Figma design space for the agency and Altis Cloud, and produced motion and marketing assets.

Creative Designer, Webstacks

San Diego, US | Mar 2021 – Aug 2022

- Worked inside the design department through agile sprints and daily stand-ups.
- Designed UI components and contributed to a broader, multi-product design system.
- Produced vector illustrations in Figma and Illustrator, plus SVG-friendly web animations in After Effects + Lottie.

Multimedia Designer, Aromen BVBA

Wevelgem, Belgium | Jan 2018 – Jul 2022

- Led cross-media projects across branding, illustration, and UI for the Aromen App and webshop (WooCommerce, later Odoo).
- Built a complete label and packaging system across hundreds of product lines.
- Produced 3D mockups, exhibition collateral, signage, and the company’s catalogues and decks.

Selected projects

Workbench (2026)

Design, Frontend, Backend

A shared planning board for the marketing team, built to replace their spreadsheets. A month calendar is home, with a forward view of the year's campaigns, a content calendar by publishing date, and a drafting room for ideas without a date yet.

Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind, SQLite

Sparrow (2026)

Design, Frontend, Backend

Shared PDF review for the team. Pin feedback to the page, reply and resolve in place, and keep the conversation across drafts, with clear links to the latest or an exact version.

Stack: React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Express, SQLite

Letter Clash (2025)

Design, Frontend, Backend

A real-time multiplayer word game built for the team, with a 20-second turn clock, live ghost tiles from your opponent, and a server that owns the rules.

Stack: React, TypeScript, Vite, WebSocket, SQLite

HM Brand Guidelines (2024 to present)

Design systems, Frontend, Agent workflows

From a static reference to a brand suite for people and agents. Shared tokens, editorial guidance and practical tools bring Human Made's brand into the conversation and the work.

Stack: Design tokens, JavaScript, Node.js, Agent skills

Skills

Design: Figma, Design systems, Prototyping, UI components, Iconography, Brand systems

Motion: After Effects, Lottie, SVG animation, Micro-interactions, Storyboards, Motion principles

Frontend: React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Live prototypes, Claude Code

Build: Node.js, Express, SQLite, WebSocket, Vite

AI and systems: Design tokens, Agent skills, Claude Code

Tools: Figma, Adobe Photoshop, InDesign, After Effects, Lottie, Sketch, React, TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind, Claude Code

Worked with

HubSpot, DJI, Human Made, Webstacks, Ogilvy